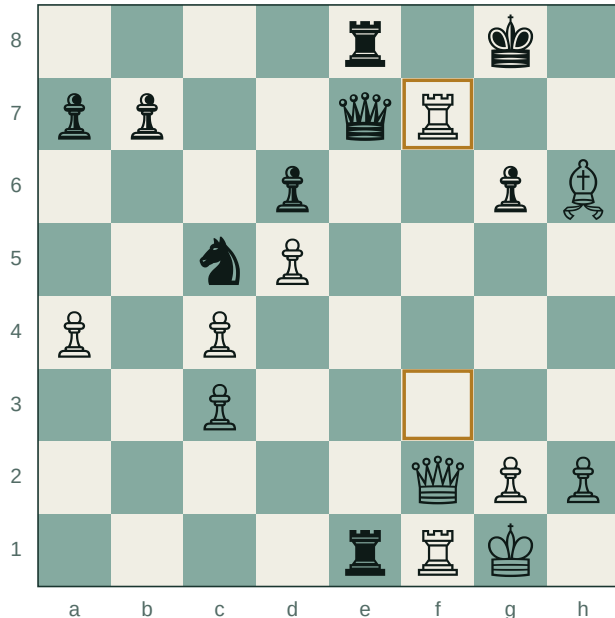


Intermediate moves: Black, move 24

Intermediate moves

Black to move



Previous move: 24.Rxf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24...Rxf1+ 25. Kxf1 Qxf7 26. Qxf7+ Kxf7

24...Rxf1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From f1 it attacks king on g1 and queen on f2. Recorded reply: **25.Kxf1**.

25...Qxf7 The queen captures the rook on f7. Recorded reply: **26.Qxf7+**.

26...Kxf7 The king captures the queen on f7.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The postponed recapture may disappear. The intermediate move must win enough or preserve the right to recover material.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An intermediate move interrupts an expected sequence with a stronger immediate threat. Instead of recapturing automatically, use a check or another forcing move to change the result.

HOW TO LOOK

Before every routine recapture, scan checks, queen attacks, and mating threats. Return to the original capture only if it still helps.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: rook on f1.